Rippling Removal for macOS

rippling_removal_macos.sh · v2.0.6 · Iru, Inc.

Removes leftover Rippling components from Macs after they migrate to Iru.

Safe by default. The script ships in dry-run mode: it scans and reports, and changes nothing until you edit one line.

Quick start

STEP	WHAT TO DO
1. Dry run	Add the script to Iru as a Custom Script and push it as-is to one test Mac. It runs as root.
2. Read the result	Open the script output in the Iru console and read the SUMMARY block at the bottom.
3. Go live	If the FOUND lines look right, change `DRY_RUN="true"` to `"false"` and push again.
4. Log out or restart	If a Rippling menu-bar icon is still visible, log out or restart. The process has already been stopped.
5. Roll out	Push live mode to your remaining Macs. The script is safe to re-run.

The two modes

One setting at the top of the script, under **Editable defaults**, controls everything:

```
DRY_RUN="true"    # DRY RUN (default) — scan and report only. Changes nothing.
DRY_RUN="false"   # LIVE — same scan, then removes what it finds.
```

Both modes run the same scan, so a dry run shows exactly what a live run will do — including whether the optional admin-account removal would be allowed or blocked.

What it does

Phase 1 · Assessment (read-only, both modes)

Checks whether the migration completed on this Mac:

- Is the Iru agent installed? (`/usr/local/bin/kandji`)
- Are any Rippling configuration profiles left? (reported only — never modified)

- Is the Rippling app still on disk? (`Rippling.app`, `RipplingMDM.app`, `/opt/rippling`, `/usr/local/rippling`)
- Are any Rippling processes still running? (This is why a menu-bar icon can linger after the files are gone.)

Phase 2 · Sweep (follows the mode setting)

Runs in this order, so nothing can relaunch mid-cleanup:

1. **Per-user LaunchAgents** — unloaded from the signed-in user's session, then removed
2. **System LaunchDaemons** — unloaded, then removed
3. **Processes** — any Rippling process still running
4. **Files and folders** — `/opt/rippling`, `/usr/local/rippling`, the app bundles, and Rippling folders in every user's Application Support (e.g., `Rippling`, `rippling-tray`)
5. **Package receipts** — every installer receipt matching Rippling
6. **Munki** — launch items, Managed Software Center, managed-install files, and receipts, where present
7. **Chef** — launch items, `chef-workstation` / `inspec`, their command shortcuts in `/usr/local/bin`, and receipts, where present
8. **Login-window text** — cleared if custom text is set
9. **Local admin account** — only if you turn on the optional setting below

Phase 3 · Summary

Counts of items found, removed, and not removed, followed by a one-line RESULT. Read the output from the bottom up.

Reading the result

RESULT	MEANING	NEXT STEP
CLEAN	Nothing left to remove.	None.
DRY RUN complete	Report only. The FOUND lines are what a live run would remove.	Review, then set `DRY_RUN="false"`.
CLEANED	Everything found was removed.	Log out or restart if a menu-bar icon lingers.
PARTIAL	Some items couldn't be removed. Each one is named in a FAILED line.	For files or processes, restart and re-run. If the admin account was **NOT removed**, fix the reason it gives first — a restart won't change it.

Output goes to the Iru console and to the macOS unified log, tagged `[rippling_removal]` (view it with `log show` or Console.app).

Exit codes: `0` = clean, dry run complete, or cleaned · `1` = a live run couldn't remove something, including a blocked admin-account removal.

Optional: remove the Rippling admin account

SETTING	DEFAULT	WHEN TURNED ON	BEFORE YOU TURN IT ON
`REMOVE_RIPPLING_ADMIN`	`"false"`	Removes the RipplingAdmin local account and its home folder, if the safety checks below pass.	Run a dry run with it on. The output says **passed preflight** or **would be BLOCKED**, with the reason. When off, the script only logs a warning.

Safety checks (both modes). The script won't remove the account if:

- the account is signed in;
- no other local admin account exists on the Mac; or
- it's the only admin with a **Secure Token** — on a FileVault-encrypted Mac, that can make it the only account able to unlock the disk at startup.

When the checks pass, the account is deleted with Apple's `sysadminctl` tool. Its home folder is removed only after the account is confirmed gone, and only if the folder still belongs to that account. A blocked removal changes nothing.

> **If the Rippling admin is the only account on the Mac,** the checks will block removal. First create an admin account for the Mac's user (System Settings → Users & Groups, while signed in as the Rippling admin). Confirm it has a Secure Token (`sudo sysadminctl -secureTokenStatus <user>` shows ENABLED) and can unlock FileVault after a restart. Then re-run.

The account name is set by `USER_TO_REMOVE="RipplingAdmin"`. Change it only if your Rippling setup used a different name. You can leave this setting off and handle the account later.

> **Munki and Chef.** These are removed as part of the standard sweep because Rippling used them to deliver software. If you use Munki or Chef independently of Rippling, remove those sections from the script before running live.

Built-in safeguards

- **Dry run by default.** The first run on any Mac only reports.
- **Enrollment is never touched.** Rippling configuration profiles are reported, never removed. Your migration process handles those.
- **Relaunch-safe order.** Background items are unloaded before processes are stopped and files deleted, so nothing restarts mid-cleanup.

- **Every removal is verified.** The script re-checks each item and reports FAILED if it's still there, so the summary is accurate.
- **Admin removal checks first.** It won't leave a Mac without another admin, or without an account that can unlock FileVault.
- **Safe to re-run.** Any mode, any number of times.

FAQ

The dry run found several items. Is that a problem? No. It means the migration didn't remove every Rippling component on that Mac — which is what this script is for. Switch to live mode.

The Rippling menu-bar icon is still showing after a live run. Did it fail? No. If the result is CLEANED, the Rippling processes were stopped and their files removed. The icon clears at the next logout or restart, and nothing remains to bring it back.

The result is PARTIAL and the admin account was "NOT removed." What now? A safety check blocked it, and nothing was changed. Fix the reason in the FAILED line — usually by creating another admin with a Secure Token — then re-run.

Can I run it more than once? Yes, in any mode, as many times as you need.

Why does the script check for "kandji"? The Iru agent is installed at `/usr/local/bin/kandji`. That's expected.